

INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

International Languages, Level 2

Open

LBACO – LDYCO

This course provides opportunities for students to develop competence and confidence in listening, speaking, reading, and writing in the language of study. Students will communicate about matters of personal interest and everyday topics in interactive settings that emphasize real-life applications, and will read and write a variety of texts of increasing complexity in the language. Students will continue to develop their understanding and appreciation of diverse communities in regions of the world where the language is spoken. They will also explore personal and professional contexts in which knowledge of the language is required, and develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

Prerequisite: International Languages, Level 1, Academic or Open

A. LISTENING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand simple and some teacher-selected complex oral texts in the target language (e.g., *make and verify predictions about key facts or ideas in a radio commercial to confirm understanding; use prior knowledge and contextual cues to infer the meaning of unfamiliar words; prepare a note-taking template before listening to a guest speaker; listen to a text multiple times to identify unfamiliar words and expressions; while listening to an oral presentation, take note of words whose meaning they need to clarify later*)

Teacher prompt: “Think about the kinds of information you need to keep track of while listening. How can you reflect those categories in your note-taking template? For example, how can you show the difference between key ideas and supporting details through the organization of the template?”

- A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information and ideas about familiar and new topics, with contextual and visual support (e.g., *produce a labelled drawing based on a classmate’s oral description of items such as articles of clothing or rooms in a house; infer a*

suitable career choice after listening to a speaker describe his or her interests; identify the main message of, and familiar vocabulary in, a radio interview or a public service announcement; identify information about movie or concert programs, times, and prices in a recorded message, and classify it using a graphic organizer; summarize key ideas in a broadcast about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit peoples, using words, pictures, or actions; identify familiar words and expressions in a target-language rap)

Teacher prompts: “What kinds of skills do you think someone with the speaker’s interests might have? How could they be used in a career?” “What was the purpose of the announcement? What familiar words or expressions did you hear while you listened to it?”

A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:** identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in social interactions and interactions about everyday matters in the target language (e.g., *use respectful body language and eye contact to convey interest and attention during a small-group discussion; interpret prompts and non-verbal cues to determine when to speak and when to listen; use brief vocal prompts to signal interest in a conversation; paraphrase the statements*

of their partner in a dialogue using familiar words and phrases, and verify the accuracy of the paraphrase with him or her)

Teacher prompts: “What type of body language might you use as a listener to signal interest or to encourage a speaker to continue?” “What non-verbal cues can a speaker give to indicate either that it is time for you to respond or that you should continue listening?”

A2.2 Interacting: respond with understanding to what others say while participating in structured interactions in the target language about familiar and new topics, with contextual and visual support (*e.g., agree or disagree with a peer’s opinions about a movie; offer comparable information in response to a peer’s description of personal interests and experiences; acknowledge the suggestions of others while making plans for the weekend with friends; respond to a peer’s survey on the use of technology; with a peer, role-play an interaction about ordering food at a restaurant; recommend a local restaurant to a peer after listening to his or her food preferences; respond to questions about the style and cost of seasonal clothing suitable for Ontario and for a country where the target language is spoken*)

Teacher prompts: “What aspects of the movie did your peer like or dislike? What details did he or she give to support that point of view?” “What kinds of food does your peer prefer? What local restaurants do you think he or she might enjoy?” “In what parts of the world would this item of clothing be useful?”

A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening; (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (*e.g., identify and describe the listening strategies they found most helpful during a group discussion; outline the learning process they go through when interpreting a recorded message, and plan steps to improve it; compare listening strategies with a peer, and plan to try a new strategy that he or she has found effective; identify occasions when they were distracted while listening, describe the circumstances, and select a strategy to use in similar listening contexts*)

Teacher prompts: “Describe the steps you take to understand a recorded message. How could you improve that process?” “As you recall an occasion when you did not listen effectively, think about the context. Was there background noise, for example, or were you trying to do

something else while you were listening? What might you do differently in similar circumstances to improve your listening skills?”

A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., view a cooking show in the target language and describe the dishes prepared; after listening to a travelogue about a region where the target language is spoken, identify some of its distinctive features; listen to oral information about family life in a target-language community and make connections to their own community; listen to music from a target-language community and compare elements such as lyrics, rhythm, tempo, and beat to the elements of Métis music or music played in another community; list key points heard in an authentic or fictional interview with a significant cultural or historical figure, using a graphic organizer; after listening to a broadcast, identify the effects of climate change on a region where the target language is spoken and compare them to the effects on their own community*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some ways that family life in the target-language community is similar to or different from your own experience? How did learning about another culture help you appreciate your own better?” “What key information about this person did the interview reveal? What does the information reflect about the target-language culture?”

A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., determine whether a speaker is introducing a friend or a stranger by identifying some differences in his or her language register; identify some regional variations in pronunciation and accent; listen to a radio commercial to identify target-language words that are borrowed from other languages*)

Teacher prompt: “What words or phrases made it clear that the speakers knew or did not know each other?”

B. SPEAKING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (*e.g., list essential vocabulary and key ideas to prepare for speaking; record and review their presentation to increase their confidence and to identify areas needing practice; practise speaking in front of a mirror or to a peer before a presentation; vary pitch, volume, and tone of voice to maintain the interest of listeners; incorporate words or expressions used by another speaker into their own speech to refine their message; use visual aids to support an oral presentation*)

Teacher prompts: “In this recording of your own presentation, listen to both the content of your message and the way you expressed it. What do you think needs to be revised?” “Tell the class five things about your topic, using a visual aid to help you explain.”

- ##### B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:
- produce rehearsed, some detailed, and spontaneous messages in the target language to communicate information and ideas about matters of personal interest and everyday topics, with contextual, auditory, and visual support (*e.g., deliver a presentation on fashion, entertainment, health care, or the workplace, using visual aids and a script; relate a childhood memory; in a group*

discussion, describe their school activities, personal interests, or plans for the future; deliver an oral report outlining their daily routines; leave a telephone message giving clear directions to a tourist attraction; compose and deliver a short speech to thank a guest speaker)

Teacher prompts: “What makes your childhood memory special? What will you say to help your listeners connect it to their own experience?” “What school activities interest you the most? How do you get involved?” “As you give directions, think about the route. What will someone see on the way? How many intersections have to be crossed?”

- ##### B1.3 Speaking with Fluency:
- speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in brief, rehearsed, and spontaneous communications in the target language about a variety of familiar topics (*e.g., give clear directions with ease; use pauses and intonation to accentuate their preferences when delivering a presentation about personal likes and dislikes; recite a familiar poem, pausing as indicated by the punctuation; accurately pronounce familiar vocabulary when discussing their interests*)

Teacher prompts: “How might you use your voice to help your audience understand how much you enjoy your favourite foods or music?” “As you prepare to recite the poem, think about the punctuation. How will it help you decide where to pause and for how long, and how it will affect your delivery?”

B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies: identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of structured, guided, formal, and informal situations while participating in simple and some detailed spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., ask questions to encourage others to share their thoughts during partner and group work; use non-verbal cues such as physical proximity and eye contact to highlight important ideas in a conversation; bridge gaps in spoken communication by repeating the message or speaking more slowly*)

Teacher prompts: “How might you emphasize an important idea non-verbally while you are having a conversation? What would make such cues useful to you if you were the listener?” “If your partner is having difficulty responding during an interaction, how might you clarify your message?”

B2.2 Interacting: engage in structured and spontaneous spoken interactions in the target language about familiar and new topics, with teacher modelling and support (*e.g., offer and respond to invitations and compliments; exchange opinions with a peer in a brief conversation about homework; with a partner, role-play an interaction related to health care or business; dramatize a scripted dialogue between an interviewer and an environmentalist about the protection of animal habitats; ask a partner for directions to the closest tourist attraction, and restate his or her answer to confirm that they have understood; collaborate with classmates to prepare and present a skit about the importance of daily physical activity; with a peer, discuss similarities and differences in young people’s spending habits in Ontario and target-language communities*)

Teacher prompts: “What kinds of compliments would you offer a classmate? How might you compliment your own parent?” “In your interview with an environmentalist, what questions can you ask to ensure that the issue is explored and explained?”

B2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., describe in a student-teacher conference how they self-monitor their speaking skills during interactions; plan to reflect on feedback from peers and the teacher on revising the content of their spoken messages; express preferences about the graphic organizers they use to prepare for speaking; plan to record and review their speech in order to identify areas for improvement; identify the most effective elements of their oral presentation, and plan to incorporate them in future presentations*)

Teacher prompts: “When you interact with peers, how do you assess whether your message is accurate and clear? In what other ways could you monitor your speaking skills?” “Which type of graphic organizer do you find most helpful as you prepare for a speaking task?”

B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 Intercultural Awareness: communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., retell or recite a traditional short narrative or a poem; describe a dance from a region where the target language is spoken and teach the steps; create a short video to demonstrate and discuss a regional or national cuisine; in pairs, conduct research on a musician or musical group from a target-language community and present the information to the class; dramatize a target-language proverb or idiomatic expression*)

Teacher prompts: “What does the cuisine of this region reveal about the way of life?” “What elements of the music performed by the person/group you researched were especially interesting or characteristic of the target-language community? In what ways?”

B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions: identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use expressions appropriate to their relationship to*

the other speakers to initiate, maintain, and close a conversation; view video clips of speakers from their own and various target-language communities to identify their use of physical proximity and body language, and mirror them in their own interactions; use the appropriate level of formality to address people in a personal, community, or workplace setting)

Teacher prompts: “How does being aware of your relationship to other people in a conversation affect your choice of expressions?” “How would your way of addressing a friend differ from the way you address someone in a workplace, such as at a part-time job?”

C. READING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension Strategies:

identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand simple texts and teacher-selected complex adapted and authentic texts in the target language, in modelled, shared, guided, and independent reading contexts (e.g., *preview the text to find familiar words and cognates that will support their understanding of the message; refer to text features such as the table of contents, titles, and captions, and to their knowledge of similar text forms, to make predictions about the topic; draw on personal experience to help them understand the author's intention; use visual cues such as illustrations, photographs, and diagrams to support their understanding of the overall message; ask questions to monitor their comprehension; note repeated words in a text to help them identify key ideas*)

Teacher prompts: “How do the visual elements of the text help you understand it? How do they help you make predictions?” “What strategies can you use while reading to remember important points?”

C1.2 Reading for Meaning:

demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in a variety of texts in the target language, including simple texts and teacher-selected complex adapted and authentic texts, with teacher support as appropriate (e.g., *restate in correct sequence events described in an e-mail or a letter;*

dramatize a text about traditional foods and/or customs in a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit community; summarize information in a newspaper article or blog; identify and record the evidence that a reviewer offers to support a movie or book critique; read a city map to determine the route to a particular location; interpret and explain the information in a graph of languages spoken in Canada; recommend a movie to peers on the basis of an online or a newspaper review; identify the key message on the home page of an environmental organization's website)

Teacher prompt: “What key factors does the graph reflect about languages spoken in Canada? How have these factors changed over time?”

C1.3 Reading with Fluency:

read texts in the target language that contain familiar vocabulary and expressions at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (e.g., *make reading aloud sound like speaking, pausing as indicated by the punctuation and using appropriate tone; while reading aloud, accurately pronounce familiar words and some words previously encountered in texts, class discussions, and/or anchor charts; use appropriate emphasis and phrasing when participating in shared reading activities*)

Teacher prompt: “As you read this text aloud, imagine that the words are being spoken rather than read. Where would a speaker naturally pause, change his or her tone of voice, or get louder or softer?”

C1.4 Developing Vocabulary: use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (*e.g., use knowledge of prefixes and suffixes to help them decode an unfamiliar form of a familiar word; take note of new words while reading, and add them to a personal word list; construct a word web on a specific topic or subtopic in a text they are reading to consolidate their vocabulary acquisition; identify jargon and slang in a magazine article, and keep a list to expand their vocabulary*)

Teacher prompt: “When part of a word is familiar but the whole word is new, how can you work out its meaning?”

C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

Forms: identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (*e.g., graphic design and descriptive text on a book jacket or DVD cover capture attention and stimulate interest; abbreviations and idiomatic expressions in a text message address a particular age group; the interplay of images and words in a comic book conveys the story; setting, plot, and characterization work together in a short story to depict the significance of imagined experiences; the arrangement of information by columns and rows in a television listing or bus schedule communicates timetables concisely; pictures and descriptions in a flyer or leaflet promote products*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the purpose of a DVD cover?” “Why do you think abbreviations are frequently used in text messages?” “How does the layout of this schedule help you quickly find the time a bus arrives?”

C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify some features and stylistic elements of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (*e.g., an image and a list of featured articles on the cover of a magazine indicate its contents; a synopsis, illustrations, and review extracts on a book jacket or DVD cover describe and endorse the product; captions, speech balloons, and graphic representations of sound effects explain the characters’ thoughts and actions in a comic book; bold type and colours emphasize key words in an*

advertisement; drop-down menus and headings with embedded links help the user navigate a website)

Teacher prompts: “What elements in this DVD cover do you find persuasive? Why?” “What effect does colour have in this advertisement?” “How did the different fonts in the speech balloons of this comic book influence your interpretation of the characters?” “What features of this environmental organization’s website help you to navigate the information presented?”

C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (*e.g., keep a reading log to track reading trends and set new goals; review their reading log to determine preferred text forms and set goals to expand the variety of texts they read; create a mind map of reading strategies, using colours, symbols, and fonts to distinguish their purposes and illustrate their usefulness; plan to seek opportunities to read the target language outside the classroom*)

Teacher prompts: “What type of text do you read most often? How do these texts build your reading skills? What new text form do you think would help you improve your skills further?” “What strategy works best to help you decode an unfamiliar word or concept as you read?” “What questions do you ask yourself to monitor your reading comprehension?”

C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., read about the benefits of learning another language, such as opportunities for careers and travel, and identify the ones they find most significant; follow written instructions to make a rain stick, piñata, or carnival mask; read an article about food traditions and customs in a country or region where the target language is spoken, and compare them to their own food traditions or those in a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit community; research sports or artistic activities in a target-language community, and*

compare them to activities in their own community; research activities and interests that are popular among young people in a target-language community, and report their findings; read an article about an environmental issue in a target-language community and make connections to a similar issue in their own community)

Teacher prompts: “What similarities and/or differences did you discover between customs and traditions related to food in different communities?” “In what ways are sports in this target-language community similar to sports in your own community? How are they different? What does that tell you about the connections between the two communities?” “What common concerns does this article describe about the issue of waste disposal? What methods do your community and the target-language community choose to address the issue?”

C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (e.g., *compare menus from various target-language communities to identify different ways of describing similar dishes; compare and contrast traffic signs and symbols in Canada and in a country or region where the target language is spoken, using a Venn diagram; read travel brochures and posters to identify words and idiomatic expressions that are unique to particular countries or regions; identify colloquialisms in a target-language blog; evaluate the level of formality in letters written by people from different target-language communities)*

Teacher prompts: “Which dishes on menus you are comparing have different names but the same or very similar ingredients?” “Which words or expressions in this letter signal the level of formality that the writer intends? Is that typical of this target-language community?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:

determine, with support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (*e.g., to use the cover of a class magazine to draw attention to a contemporary issue or trend; to advertise special offers with a flyer; to inform their peers in a blog entry about an interesting activity, person, or place; to request information about a social event from a friend by e-mail; to compose a survey to find out about the environmental practices of peers at home; to script a newscast for classmates about community events*)

Teacher prompts: “What questions can help you identify the topic, purpose, and audience for your writing?” “How will your choice of target audience affect the content of your flyer?” “What words and phrases could you incorporate into your survey to appeal to your peers?”

- D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms:** write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of some structural and stylistic elements of each form (*e.g., directions to a specific location; a résumé tailored for a part-time job; a paragraph comparing academic and professional dress codes; a captioned photo essay about a trip; a public service announcement promoting healthy eating; a critique of a*

sports or arts event; an announcement for the school website or parents’ council about a school environmental initiative; a fundraising plan to defray the cost of a trip)

Teacher prompts: “How might your choice of photographs illustrate the highlights of your trip? How can you make your captions complement the photographs?” “How does repeating key words in a public service announcement help the reader understand its intention?” “What descriptive words and phrases would effectively highlight the positive and negative aspects of the event presented in your critique?”

- D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing Content:** generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using some pre-writing strategies and resources, during modelled, shared, guided, and independent writing activities (*e.g., engage in free writing to generate ideas for a poem, rap, or song; create a*

checklist and/or a graphic organizer to assist them in organizing their ideas; use a point-form outline to put their ideas into a logical sequence before creating a survey; rank their points in order of importance before writing a response to a peer's blog; make a flow chart before writing a procedural text; share writing ideas with and seek feedback from peers)

Teacher prompt: "What techniques can you use to organize your main ideas and supporting details before you begin writing?"

D2.2 Drafting and Revising: plan and produce drafts in the target language following a model, and revise their writing using a variety of strategies, with teacher support (e.g., use sentence starters or teacher-prepared templates to help them structure a rough draft; prioritize ideas and information to improve the organization of their draft and clarify its message; use teacher-generated checklists and student exemplars as guides when revising the structure of their draft; while writing a draft, consult print and online resources to confirm spelling and enrich their vocabulary; insert connecting words to signal transitions between paragraphs; share their written work in small groups to obtain suggestions for improvements)

Teacher prompts: "What kinds of resources can you consult to vary your vocabulary?" "Review the beginnings and ends of the paragraphs in your draft. How can you ensure that the beginning of each paragraph is clearly connected to the end of the previous paragraph? What words or phrases could you add to help the reader understand the transitions in your argument?"

D2.3 Producing Finished Work: make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use some elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., add an appendix to provide supplementary information; add organizational elements such as sidebars and effective spacing to highlight key information; use font size and/or style to distinguish headings and subheadings; add appropriate graphic elements to support key ideas in the text)

Teacher prompt: "Would the visual elements of your work help the reader better understand your message if they were positioned differently within the text?"

D2.4 Metacognition:

- (a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing;
- (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., after a writing activity, complete a self-assessment of

their use of elements associated with the selected text form in order to plan next steps; keep a portfolio of strategies that were helpful during the writing process; in a writing journal, reflect on the usefulness of peer and teacher feedback; use exit passes to reflect on the writing they have just completed)

Teacher prompt: "What were the strongest aspects of your writing in this text form? What aspects were you least satisfied with? When you produce a new work in that text form, what will you do differently?"

D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 Intercultural Awareness: in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., write and perform a jingle promoting a tourist attraction in a region where the target language is spoken; write a paragraph comparing their school life with that of peers in a country or region where the target language is spoken; in a blog entry, describe a significant individual, such as an indigenous person, from a country or region where the target language is spoken; create a storyboard about a cultural festival in a country where the target language is spoken; compose a poem or song lyrics celebrating various world cultures, including First Nations, Métis, and Inuit peoples in Canada; create a menu, including prices, for a traditional meal; create a flyer promoting conservation efforts in a region where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: "What do you consider typical aspects of your school life? Talk to an exchange student or read a blog to find out whether they are also typical in a country where the target language is spoken. What differences surprised you? How does your school day differ from theirs?" "What are the most significant facts about this individual? Has he or she made an important contribution to the arts or sciences, the environment, or politics? How was it unique?" "What connections can you find between the celebrations of different world cultures? How are they similar to one another? How are they similar to a celebration in your own community?"

D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their written work in the target language (*e.g., compose a poem containing some common target-language colloquialisms; create a cartoon panel with a caption that includes an idiomatic expression specific to a country or region; use an appropriate salutation and language register in an e-mail to a friend and another to a teacher*)

Teacher prompt: “As you prepare to write your cartoon caption, select an idiomatic expression from your reading. How can you incorporate it? How would you present the same cartoon in your first language? How do such expressions expand your cultural knowledge?”